



Gender Based Violence

S I T U A T I O N

1st Quarter 2026

1. Overview

Women and girls in Somalia continue to experience heightened exposure and safety risks to Gender Based Violence as the first quarter of 2026 unfolds. Conflict, climate displacement have created a challenging environment, particularly in high-density Internally Displaced Population (IDP) hubs and conflict affected districts including Banadir (Daynile and Kahda), Lower Juba (Kismayo and Afmadow), Gedo (Doolow, Luuq, Belet Xaawo, Garbahaarey, Baardheere, and Ceel Waaq), Bay (Baidoa, Qansax Dheere, Hudur, and Diinsoor), Mudug (Hobyo, South Galkacyo, and Jariban), and Hiraan and Middle Shebelle (Belet Weyne, Jowhar, Adan Yabaal, Mahaday, Balcad, and Cadale).¹

¹GBV Coordination meeting - Reports from GBV coordinators at State levels February 2026

Key Geographic Hotspots and Risk Factors – Quarter 1, 2026

Region	Primary Risk Factors	Most Affected Districts
Lower Shabelle	Military operations, clan-based violence, and climate displacement.	Afgoye, Bariire corridors.
Banadir	High-density IDP overcrowding and lack of secure infrastructure.	Daynile, Kahda.
Gedo	Ongoing conflict and harassment during resource collection.	Doolow, Luuq, Baardheere, Belet Xaawo.
Bay	Heightened threats for women faced by armed groups due to unique vulnerabilities and displacement	Baidoa, Hudur, Diinsoor, Qansax Dheere.
Middle Shabelle	Heightened threats for women faced by armed groups due to unique vulnerabilities and displacement	Jowhar, Balcad, Adan Yabaal.
Hiraan	Armed group activity and safety concerns at water points.	Belet Weyne,
Mudug	Regional instability and physical safety threats.	Hobyo, South Galkacyo, Jariban.

**The highest risks have been identified in Internally Displaced Population (IDP) hubs and districts affected by conflict, including*

The 2026 Talk to Loop Report highlighted a significant number of cases (Protection and GBV) across several regions: Lower Shabelle (2,781); Galgaduud (220); Middle Shabelle (211); Hiraan (210); and Gedo (210). The surge in Lower Shabelle is primarily driven by the active military operations and clan-based insecurity, armed groups; and climate induced displacement in Afgoye and Bariire corridors. The data reveals how different groups experience or perceive harm. A total of 61 percent of women and girls reported direct physical safety threats, compared to (39 percent) of men and boys.²

²Talk to Loop Report Publication 2026

Region	Reported Cases	Primary Drivers of Risk
Lower Shabelle	2,781	Military operations, clan violence, and climate displacement (Afgoye/Bariire).
Galgaduud	220	Insecurity and lack of stable protection services.
Middle Shabelle	211	Displacement-related vulnerabilities and armed group activity.
Hiraan	210	Conflict-affected routes and resource scarcity.
Gedo	210	Harassment at water/firewood points and domestic risks.

**Talk to loop publication quarter 1 2026*

The Gender Gap Analysis

There is a stark “gendered divide” in how people experience systematic failure in the above regions. While women fear for their lives and bodies, men are more likely to report issues with the distribution of resources.

- Women & Girls (61 percent) of cases reported focuses on physical safety. This includes threats encountered while performing daily chores (collecting water/firewood) and risks within the home.
- Men & Boys (39 percent) of cases reported focuses on aid and services. This includes grievances regarding aid diversion and failures in how services are delivered.

Specific GBV Risks (OXFAM Analysis)

Beyond the numbers, qualitative research from IDP sites in Baardheere, Beletweyne, and Laascaanod highlights three critical areas of concern:

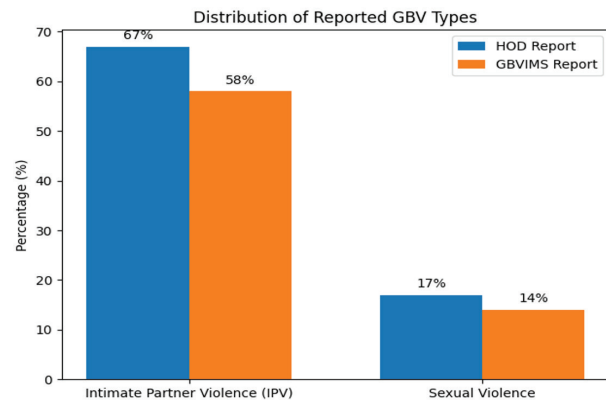
- **Domestic Threats:** High prevalence of Intimate Partner Violence (IPV).
- **Harmful Practices:** A rise in early and forced marriages as a misguided coping mechanism.
- **Environmental Risks:** Women and girls are most vulnerable to harassment when walking to water points or traveling remote routes to collect firewood.



Key GBV Types

This report uses comparative data for key GBV types from the Himilo Organization for Development (HOD) report and GBVIMS. The HOD GBV rapid assessment 2026 presents perceptions of GBV incidence in IDP camps in Luuq district of the Gedo region; While the GBVIMS quarter four report presented data collated by 23 GBV service organizations in Somalia that indicate trends in GBV types and service provision.

Comparable data of the HOD and GBVIMS reports revealed 2 Key GBV types observed in 4th quarter of 2025 and first quarter of 2026 - intimate partner violence (IPV – 67% -HOD; 58% GBVIMS) and Sexual violence (17% - HOD and 14% GBVIMS). 71% of women and girls that have lodged a report in this



period, identified safety concerns to include unlit pathways and latrines during night-time; lonely routes to waterpoints and firewood collection while 36% reported day time safety concerns. Other risks include open defecation and harassment in public spaces.³

Gender-Based Violence (GBV) Trends

Comparative data from the Himilo Organization for Development (HOD) and GBVIMS for Q4 2025 and Q1 2026 identifies Intimate Partner Violence (IPV) as the most prevalent GBV type, followed by sexual violence.

Comparison - Regional (Luuq/Gedo) vs. National Trends in Percentage Q4 -2025 and Q1 2026

Region	HOD Data (Luuq/Gedo)	GBVIMS Data (National Trends)
Intimate Partner Violence (IPV)	67	58
Sexual Violence	17	14

**These figures represent reported cases through the GBVIMS quarter 4 2025 and HOD 2026 GBV assessments.*

IPV remains the most prevalent form of GBV in both datasets, though the Luuq/Gedo district shows a higher concentration at 67 percent.

Both regional and national figures indicate that sexual violence accounts for roughly 1 in 7 reported cases, highlighting a critical need for continued protection service.

³HOD Assessment report, 2026

The safety of women is heavily dictated by environmental factors and infrastructure. Below is the breakdown of reported safety concerns. The risk of GBV at night-time nearly doubles (from (36 percent) to (71 percent) once the sun sets. This directly correlates with the lack of energy infrastructure (solar streetlights).

Time	% of Women Reporting Concerns	Key Risk Factors & Hazards
Night-time	71	Lack of solar lighting on pathways, unlit/non-lockable latrines, and high-risk dark routes used for collecting firewood and water.
Day-time	36	Harassment in public spaces, risks associated with open defecation due to lack of private facilities, and exhaustion/exposure during long-distance trekking.

Services Limitations



Specialized GBV services are currently in a state of crisis due to drastic funding cuts. Closures of GBV facilities including Women and girls' safe spaces (WGSS) and GBV One stop centers (GBV OSCs); and the reduction of GBV service staff due to severity of funding gaps. These were primary inhibitors to access to service.

Out of a total of 120 registered GBV centers, 66 (55%) are currently closed or non-operational. This includes Women and Girls' Safe Spaces (WGSS) and One-Stop Centers (OSCs). In remote areas, the culture of silence persists not only due to stigma but due to the physical absence of any confidential reporting mechanism. The reduction in GBV specialized services is the most urgent barrier to survivor recovery.

The Facility Crisis: A Statistical Breakdown

Facility Status	Count	Percentage
Total Registered GBV Centers	120	100
Active/Operational	54	45
Closed/Non-Operational	66	55

**GBV coordinators sub national coordinator's reports*

The HOD report on incidence of child and forced marriage is a major concern as child marriage provides conditions for exploitation and IPV - predisposing the child to increased future GBV risks. Economic vulnerability is the primary driver of IPV and Early Forced Marriage (50% incidence in HOD data).

Groups most vulnerable

Reports during the quarter four of 2025 and quarter one of 2026 identified groups most vulnerable to GBV risks to include: Adolescent girls, female headed households, minority clan women, persons with disabilities and newly displaced women and girls.

GBV Incidence by Settlement Type (Q4 2025)

Settlement Type	Percentage GBV Incidents	Key Risk Factors & Environmental Drivers
IDP Settlements	73	High congestion, lack of household privacy, flimsy/poor shelters, unlit pathways, and non-lockable latrines.
Host Communities	27	Limited access to specialized services, social stigma, and economic stressors within the household.

**GBVIMS Report 2025*

Key Challenges

- Massive funding cuts across the county have forced 55% of GBV facilities to close, leaving survivors with nowhere to go for confidential help.
- While cash assistance has helped, it is currently not enough to reach the vast number of women in need.
- Reporting of sexual harassment remains dangerously low because many survivors fear social stigma or do not know how to report safely.

Urgent action

- Well-lit and lockable latrines in IDP camps (WASH, Camp committees)
- Sustained use of cash assistance through case management to meet urgent needs (CASH ACTORS)
- Need to support the re-opening of women and girls' safe spaces. (GBV Actors)
- Broader dissemination of PSEA messaging among key clusters (Food, WASH, Health)

Conclusion

Women and girls in Somalia remain at high risk of gender-based violence due to ongoing conflict, droughts floods and multiple displacements. While the 2026 Talk to the Loop report showed a high level of reported protection concerns, the actual capacity to help these survivors has been severely weakened. These risks are mainly due to food insecurity, and weak physical and economic security.

Service limitation because of funding cuts and closure of GBV service sites impact on the ability of GBV survivors to access services. Increased response of cash assistance through case management in the 4th quarter of 2025 and the first quarter 2026 improved GBV survivors' ability to access services; however, this is still inadequate for the large population of women and girls with GBV, and protection needs. PSEA reporting is still low because of stigma, lack of confidence or ignorance of existing reporting channels.

